

ETHICS MIDTERMS LESSONS

Ethics or Morality is essentially a Philosophy subject.

The term **Philosophy** came from the two Greek words:

Philos – Love

Sophia – Wisdom

Ethics came from its Greek word “**ETHOS**”

“*Ethos*” means a characteristic way of doing things or body of customs.

Ethics is a **practical science** which is meant to teach how humans ought to live.

The word Moral is derived from the Latin word “**MOS**” which means custom.

Rules are instructions that tell what we are allowed to do and what we are not allowed to do.

Rules are important because:

- Rules organize relations between individuals
- Rules make it clear what is right to do/follow in a society and what are wrong to refrain from
- Rules provide opportunity to achieve personal and societal goals
- Rules regulate various social institutions to fulfill their integral roles for the common welfare

“Absence of rules makes human life **DIFFICULT**.”

In terms of **Freedom** – life's freedom would unlikely to be enjoyed without rules. Everything in our life should be regulated with rules or it becomes a mess. If there are no rules and everyone is free to do whatever they want, most people will probably behave selfishly.

Morals – refer to the social, cultural and religious beliefs or values practiced overtime by an individual or group which direct people to do what is customarily allowable as right or refrain from those that society prohibits as “taboo” or wrong.

Key Differences between Morals and Ethics	
Morals	Ethics
- Deal with what is right or wrong	- Deals with what is good and evil
- Dictated by society, culture or religion	- Chosen by the person himself who governs his life under the dictate of right reason
- May vary from society to society and culture to culture	- It remains the same regardless of any culture, religion or society
- Expressed in the form of statements	- The principles are translated into an explicit (malinaw o tiyak) action

Moral Standards – deal with matters, which can seriously injure or seriously benefit human beings

Non-Moral Standards - Refer to rules that are unrelated to moral or ethical considerations. **It's just a matter of taste or preference.**

6 characteristics of Moral Standards to differentiate them from non-moral standards:

1. Moral standards involve serious wrongs or significant benefits.
2. Moral standards ought to be preferred to other values.
3. Moral standards are not established by authority figures.
4. Moral standards have the trait of universalizability.
5. Moral standards are based on impartial considerations.
6. Moral standards are associated with special emotions (i.e., guilt) and vocabulary.

MORAL DILEMMA

1. Dilemma

A **dilemma** is a situation where a person has to choose between **two or more difficult options**, and **none of the choices are easy**.

Example:

You have an important exam tomorrow, but your close friend suddenly needs your help.

2. Moral Dilemma

A **moral dilemma** happens when the choices involve **moral values** such as right vs. wrong, honesty, justice, or responsibility.

Example:

You promised to keep your friend's secret, but the secret could harm someone.

Should you **keep your promise** or **protect the other person**?

3. Non-Moral Dilemma

A **non-moral dilemma** is a difficult choice, but **it does not involve moral right or wrong**. It is simply a matter of **preference, convenience, or practicality**.

A non-moral dilemma involves a choice between options that do not have moral significance.

The options may be difficult to choose from, but the decision does not involve ethical considerations of right and wrong.

Key Features of a Non-Moral Dilemma:

- Does Not Involve Moral Principles: The choice is practical rather than ethical.
- May Be Challenging but Not Ethical: The difficulty comes from personal preference, resources, or external constraints.
- No Right or Wrong Answer in a Moral Sense: Any choice made does not violate ethical values.

Two Kinds of Relativism

1. Subjective Relativism
2. Cultural Relativism

Example:

You must choose between:

- Studying at home
- Studying in a coffee shop

Both choices are **not morally right or wrong**.

Very Simple Comparison

Type	Meaning	Example
Dilemma	A difficult choice between options	Study or attend a friend's party
Moral Dilemma	Choice involving right and wrong	Tell the truth or protect a friend
Non-Moral Dilemma	Choice involving preference only	Coffee or tea

Types of Dilemma**1. Classic Dilemma**

A **classic dilemma** occurs when a person must choose between **two conflicting moral choices**, and **both options have negative consequences**.

Example:

You promised your friend to keep a secret, but the secret could harm someone.

- Keep the promise (loyalty)
- Tell the truth to prevent harm (honesty)

Both involve **important moral values**.

2. Temporal Dilemma

A **temporal dilemma** happens when a person must choose between **immediate benefit and long-term benefit**.

Example:

A student can:

- Party the night before the exam (immediate enjoyment), or
- Study for the exam (future academic success).

The conflict is **present satisfaction vs future responsibility**.

3. Orthogonal Dilemma

An **orthogonal dilemma** occurs when the choices involve **different values or priorities that are not directly comparable**, making it difficult to decide.

Example:

A graduate must choose between:

- A high-paying job in the city, or
- Working in a community service job with lower pay but helping people.

The options represent **different life values** (money vs service).

4. Sequential Dilemma

A **sequential dilemma** happens when **one decision leads to another ethical decision**, creating a chain of dilemmas.

Example:

A company manager first decides whether to hide a mistake.

If the mistake is hidden, the manager later faces another dilemma:

- Continue lying, or
- Admit the mistake.

Each decision **creates another ethical situation**.

5. Unequal Dilemma

An **unequal dilemma** happens when **one option is morally better than the other**, but the wrong choice may still be tempting or easier.

Example:

A student can:

- Study honestly for an exam, or
- Cheat to get a higher grade.

The ethical choice is **clear**, but the person still experiences a dilemma.

Simple Summary

Type of Dilemma Meaning		Example
Classic	Two conflicting moral choices	Loyalty vs honesty
Temporal	Present benefit vs future benefit	Party vs study
Orthogonal	Different life values	High salary vs community service
Sequential	Chain of ethical decisions	Hiding a mistake leads to more lies
Unequal	One choice clearly more ethical	Study vs cheat

Types of Moral Dilemma

1. Personal Moral Dilemma

A **personal moral dilemma** happens when the conflict is **within the individual**, and the decision mainly affects the **person's own values, conscience, or relationships**.

Example:

A student sees a close friend cheating during an exam.

- Report the cheating (honesty)
- Protect the friend (loyalty)

The student must decide based on **personal moral values**.

2. Organizational Moral Dilemma

An **organizational moral dilemma** happens **within a group, company, or institution**, where a person must decide between **following organizational rules or doing what seems morally right**.

Example:

A company employee discovers that the company is hiding product defects from customers.

- Follow company orders and stay silent
- Report the issue to protect consumers

The dilemma involves **organizational loyalty vs ethical responsibility**.

3. Systemic (Systematic) Moral Dilemma

A **systemic moral dilemma** happens when the problem is caused by **the larger system or structure of society**, such as laws, policies, or social systems.

Example:

A doctor in a public hospital has only **one available ventilator**, but two patients urgently need it. The doctor must decide **who will receive the life-saving treatment**.

The dilemma is created by **limited resources in the healthcare system**.

Simple Summary

Type	Meaning	Example
Personal	Moral conflict within a person	Reporting a cheating friend
Organizational	Moral problem in a workplace or group	Employee exposing company wrongdoing
Systemic	Moral issue caused by social systems or policies	Doctor choosing which patient to treat

"Morality was based on reason alone, and once we understood it, we would see that acting morally is the same as acting rationally" - Immanuel Kant

Filipino Moral Character

Filipinos have been described as:

- Friendly
- Outgoing
- Sensitive
- Easily offended
- Hospitable
- Witty
- Generous
- Easy

Strengths of Filipino Character

A. PAKIKIPAGKAPWA-TAO

1. Pakikipagkapwa-tao – basic sense of justice and fairness, concern for others and ability to empathize with others
2. Pakikiramdam – sensitivity to people's feelings.
3. Utang na loob – sense of gratitude
4. Camaraderie – the feeling of closeness to one another.

B. Strong Family Ties

C. Joy And Humor

D. Flexibility, Adaptability and Creativity

E. Hard Work and Industry

F. Faith and Religiosity

Filipino Positive Values

Filipino values shape our relationships, behaviors, choices and sense of who we are.

- a. **Hospitality** – it's one of the most popular traits of Filipinos. We are usually friendly and welcoming to our guests. We can also understand and speak English.
- b. **Helpful to others/Bayanihan** - unity in bayanihan spirit manifests our close relationship with our neighbors
- c. **Respectful** – Filipinos are courteous people. Po at Opo. Mano po. Sir and Ma'am.
- d. **Bravery** – There is a hero's blood running on our veins.
- e. **Jolliness and Sense of Humor** – The Philippines is a country of smile. Nothing can take away the humor and jolliness on many Filipinos.
- f. **Discretion and dignity** – many Filipinos still observe delicadeza: hiya, always think twice before they make a decision that can affect their dignity and honor.

- g. **Gratefulness** – Filipinos are thankful. Utang na loob – sense of gratefulness.
- h. **Honesty and commitment** – “palabra de honor”: we try our best to fulfill our promises.
- i. **Helpfulness** – even if the Philippines is not a big and rich country, we still grant aids to other countries in need.
- j. **Family-oriented** – Filipinos are willing to make big sacrifices just to make sure that their loved ones will have a good a life. Our parents will do anything just to give us a brighter future.

Weakness of Filipino character

- a. **Extreme Personalism** – pine Personal lahat ng bagay. Professionalism was compromised.
- b. **Extreme Family Centeredness** - refers to the tendency to place family loyalty and obligations above fairness, merit, or the common good. Some family members rely too much on others instead of developing independence.
- c. **Lack of Discipline** - which can be described as the tendency to do what is prohibited or ignore rules simply because they are enforced. Breaking rules when no authority is present.
- d. **Passivity and Lack of Initiative** – There is a strong reliance on others. Refers to the tendency to wait for instructions or pressure before taking action.
- e. **Colonial Mentality** – lack of patriotism and actual preference for foreign things.
- f. **Kanya-kanya Syndrome** – Filipinos have a selfish, self-serving attitude that generates a feeling and competitiveness toward others.
- g. **Lack of Self-analysis and Self-reflection** – we have the tendency to avoid examining one’s own thoughts, actions, and mistakes.

Filipino Negative Values

- a. **Fatalism** – an attitude of “what goes around, comes around” or “come what may”
- b. **Crab Mentality** – refers to the behavior of preventing someone from achieving something due to jealousy or envy. “If I can’t have it, you too as well”
- c. **Ningas-kugon** – an idiom meant to illustrate how Filipinos initially exhibit great enthusiasm in the beginning but fades away just as quickly.
- d. **Filipino time** – refers to the Filipinos’ own unique brand of time, which is known to be minutes or hours behind the standard time.

- e. **Mañana Habit or Procrastination** - “mamaya na”. Instead of working on a task while there is much time, we wait for the deadline because we feel lazy to start on them, or we want to use the time in other things.
- f. **Corruption** – one of the biggest social ills our country has continued to face. The “culture of corruption” is embedded deep within our system.
- g. **Gossiping** – Filipinos are fond of talking about others’ business. Secrets are brought out; failures and flaws are emphasized, and relationships are destroyed.

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